MOUNTAIN REVIEW

OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER OF THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Volume V | Issue III | Summer 2015

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THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Summer Barbeque

SUNDAY, AUG. 2, 2015 – 1:00 p.m. – ADOBE BUILDING – 157 MOFFETT BLVD.



Giant spinning teacups! Flying elephants! Speeding bobsleds! What do they all have in common? Well, anyone who grew up in California over the past six decades can probably tell you they're all popular rides at Disneyland. What many people don't know is that all of these iconic attractions were made right here in Mountain View by amusement park ride manufacturer Arrow Development!

Arrow's original building – constructed in 1946 – still stands at 243 Moffett Boulevard. The company's "big break" came in 1953, when Walt Disney hired Arrow to help engineer and manufacture six of Disneyland's original attractions. Arrow relocated to a larger plant at 1555 Plymouth Avenue after the success of the Matterhorn Bobsled attraction, the world's first modern steel roller coaster. The company went on to achieve great success designing rides and roller coasters.

July 17, 2015 is the 60th anniversary of Disneyland and the MVHA is marking the occasion by dedicating our Summer BBQ to Arrow Development and the prominent role it played in the park's creation. So in addition to all the traditional MVHA Summer BBQ fun (Parisian burgers! Raffles! Music!), we are bringing a bit of the "Happiest Place on Earth" to Mountain View!

DISNEYLAND RIDE SYSTEMS "MADE IN MV"

1955
*Mad Tea Party**
*Snow White's Adventures**
*Mr. Toad's Wild Ride**
*King Arthur Carrousel**
Casey Jr. Circus Train
Dumbo Flying Elephants

*Present on opening day, July 17, 1955

1957
Midget Autopia

1958
Alice in Wonderland

1959
Matterhorn Bobsleds

1961
Flying Saucers

1963
Mark VI redesign of Autopia

1966
It's a Small World

1967
Pirates of the Caribbean
Adventure Thru Inner Space

1969
Haunted Mansion



We are thrilled to announce that legendary Disney "Imagineer" Bob Gurr will be our event's guest speaker and will share stories from his long career as Disney's chief ride vehicle designer. If you ever admired the sleek design of the Disneyland monorail, or if your first time driving a car was in one of the park's miniature "Autopia" vehicles , then you've experienced first-hand his remarkable work. Bob's talk is sure to be fascinating!



BBQ ticket order forms were sent last week, but you can find another order form on Page 7. So dust off those mouse ears and join us on August 2!



MOUNTAIN REVIEW

This newsletter is published four times a year by the
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042
www.mountainviewhistorical.org

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In Memoriam

Geraldine Weir
July 16, 1927 – February 8, 2015

Joseph Teresi
September 25, 1930 – May 14, 2015

Betty C. Monroe
October 25, 1922 – July 1, 2014

Audrey Jarvis Hoke
May 27, 2013

Richard Stern Weir
September 20, 2012

News & Notes

President's Message

By Patricia Figueroa
MVHA President



On May 3rd we had a very successful spring event at the former Blue & Gold Kennel Club. Thank you to Gilda Wunderman and Toshi Kumagai for opening the Wunderman House to the MVHA. Our volunteer tour guides did a wonderful job of guiding our guests through the house. While waiting for their tour, guests enjoyed snacks and some great live music. Thank you to everyone who participated in making this event so successful —we were able to introduce the MVHA to a great number of Mtn. View residents.

At our last meeting, the MVHA Board voted to allocate funds for an interpretive sign that will be located in the new Veterans' Memorial located at Eagle Park at 650 Franklin Street. The memorial will be located in the colonnaded plaza near the park's poolhouse. As many of you know, the center of the plaza features the historic flagpole and war memorial plaques from Mtn. View Union High School. A few months ago, the flagpole base was removed from the site for necessary reconstruction and a "time capsule" was discovered with a variety of things placed there by the city employees who worked on the Eagle Park project.

Sometimes as residents we think that when city employees are working on a project, it's "just another job." But the contents of the capsule are a nice reminder of what dedicated civil servants we have. I'd like to share with you one of the items discovered, an "Inter-Office Memorandum" dated November 7, 1989 (about three weeks after the big September 1989 earthquake), which is partly transcribed below:

To: The Future ; From: Harvey Tregembo, Facilities Superintendent

As I sit here writing this note for the time capsule I am struck by how many things this flagpole and its base really represent. It is a statement of respect and recognition for those who have gone on before us. It is also a symbol of the new spirit within this City, but most of all for me it represents all of the intangible things the Facilities Department stands for. The fine craftsmanship and care used in constructing the base speak to the limitless abilities of this crew. The effort to actually build it is evidence of the "Can Do" attitude that allowed this project to be a success during a time of incredible workload. The involvement in this project is an example of the strong desire to "Serve with Excellence."

Harvey's memo goes on to say a few kind words about each member of his team. We don't have the space to print the full memo here, but their names are Larry Barton, Gary Bartos, Fay Beatty, Joe Gallegos, Wilma Haftel, Bruce Mallory, Tom Morrisey, Ken "Sarge" Schmidtke, Gary Spears, Dave Trotter, and Jesus Zuniga. Harvey concluded the memo by writing, "I have never found it so easy to say good things about people nor found a group of people I admire so much."

Harvey, from the future – Thanks for sharing! And to his Facilities Department crew – thanks for working so hard to preserve this piece of Mtn. View history! We look forward to seeing the flag pole gain even deeper meaning as part of the Veterans Memorial.

Financial Report

By John Figueroa
MVHA Treasurer

Checking Account Balance as of 3/11/15: $ 5,330.65
- Income: $499.59
- Expenses: $984.58

Checking Account Balance as of 6/3/15: $ 4, 845.66

Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 12/10/14: $83,137.44
Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 6/3/15: $83,224.97

History Center Update

By Candace Bowers
MVHA Vice President



New to the History Center:
Greg David has donated panoramic photos of the Highway School's class of 1954 and Mountain View High School's class of 1958 (then and now), and a large aerial photo of Holy Cross High School and its surroundings in the 1960s.

Teri Metcalf has donated a copy of her new memoir, Rambler Rose, about growing up in California during the 1950s and 1960s. In her acknowledgment, she credits MVHA's Barbara Kinchen for her invaluable research into historical accuracy.

Join Our History Center Team!
The Mountain View History Center is looking for volunteers to join our team. Help us share Mountain View's historic archives with the public. With your help, we can offer longer hours and greater access to this invaluable resource. For more information, send an email to Candace Bowers at candace.bowers@mountainview.gov or call (650) 903-6890.

The Mountain View History Center

Mountain View Public Library, 2nd Floor – 585 Franklin Street
Mtn. View, CA 94041

Open from 1:00-5:00 p.m. every Tuesday & by appointment.
For more information, call (650) 903-6890.

The Mtn. View History Center's mission is to collect, organize and make available Mountain View historical resources and to promote the City's heritage. It contains the historic archives of both the MVHA and the Mtn. View Public Library. Mtn. View history books and pamphlets are also available for purchase at the History Center.

Immigrant House Update

By Marina Marinovich
MVHA Publicity Chair



It's a big win for the Immigrant House and its new home at 771 North Rengstorff Avenue! The City Council voted unanimously to approve the new park design with the Immigrant House as the focal point of the 1.2-acre lot.

And what a wonderful and conceptually different park design the community has created—commemorating the valley's history while spotlighting our agrarian roots, a sanctuary that also celebrates our wildlife and native plants. The plan includes a demonstration garden while preserving a large heritage tree canopy for current and future generations to enjoy—a new home for demonstration gardeners, beekeepers, and history buffs.

The centerpiece of the park will be Mountain View's Immigrant House that housed laborers and migrant workers more than a century ago. The structure will be restored to its historically accurate configuration with a large deck surrounding it, and will be used as an educational display.

The City purchased the land in 2013 from longtime resident Frances Stieper, who rejected larger offers from developers to ensure that her property would be preserved as some type of public open space. Her vision will soon become a reality.

We have raised $73,000 of the $180,000 needed to restore the building, and city officials have agreed to cover an additional $90,000 in estimated costs. That leaves us with $17,000 of fundraising to do. We are currently applying for a grant from the Santa Clara Historical Grant Program. For those who can contribute and wish to get a 501[c] tax-deductible donation, leave a message at the Los Altos Community Foundation Mountain View Immigrant House Fund at (650) 949-5908.

Assuming all goes smoothly, construction on the new park will begin next spring with the goal of finishing by the end of 2016. Thank you, everyone, for contributing. We still have a little ways to go with fundraising, but all in all, this is a time to celebrate!

SPRING 2015 EVENT RECAP

Photos by Andrew Quiroz

Guests enter the historic Wunderman House, former home of the Blue and Gold Kennel Club 1920s speakeasy.



A glimpse of the 1920s-era speakeasy bar in the basement of the Blue and Gold Kennel Club.



MVHA Publicity Chair Marina Marinovich and Mtn. View Mayor John McAlister at the event.



Eugene Sharp's 1936 Buick Convertible added to the historic atmosphere and offered a great photo op for guests.

Our spring 2015 event was the bees knees! Thanks to the hospitality of Gilda Wunderman and Toshi Kumagai, we left our normal stomping grounds at the Adobe Building and stepped inside the Wunderman House, the infamous home of the Blue and Gold Kennel Club—a Prohibition-era speakeasy, bordello, and gambling hall.

Guests were treated to guided tours of this rambling 7,200 square-foot structure, built c. 1924. Before and after tours, guests enjoyed food, drink, and live ragtime music. For those who missed out, we hope to hold another event at the Wunderman House soon!



Nick Perry and Mark Perry, father and son tour guide duo, in the original hat checkroom of the speakeasy bar.



Guests explore the former speakeasy chemistry lab.



Bobby Kinchen, Hip Telmont, and Betty Engberg enjoy a conversation in the front yard.



Toshi Kumagai (far left) and Nick Perry (far right) prepare to lead a group of guests into the house for a tour.



Membership Chair June Casey (left) and Hospitality Chair Helen Hughes.



Guests explore the historic stone grotto on the grounds, used for dancing in the 1920s.



A young guest enjoys a treat from the hospitality table.



The former speakeasy's basement ballroom, featuring its original one-inch thick oak dance floor.



Local musicians Jeff Leeds and Paul Reginelli ready to entertain guests with live ragtime music.

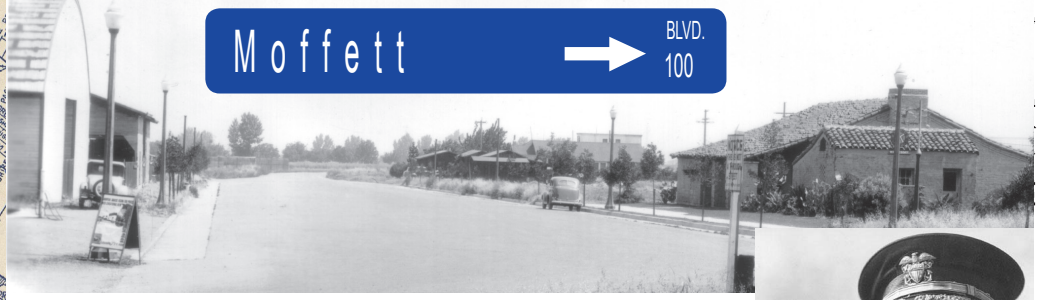


Decked out in 1920s garb, Nancy Sharp and her husband, Historical Data Chair Eugene Sharp, relax on the house's front porch.



A peek at the former speakeasy's upstairs casino room, now a library.

Street Talk



1937 view of Moffett Blvd. looking north from the railroad

By Nick Perry
Newsletter Editor

In anticipation of our summer event highlighting Arrow Development at 243 Moffett Boulevard, let's take a look back at the origins of this prominent street.

In order to understand the naming of Moffett Boulevard, some background on the naming of Moffett Field is necessary. When Congress authorized spending $5 million dollars to establish a new West Coast Navy air base in 1929, a fierce competition erupted between San Diego and the Bay Area to "win" the base. Our region rallied to purchase the former Ynigo Rancho for the base. Although not within city limits, the area was generally considered part of Mtn. View's hinterland.

Bay Area air base boosters worried that distant Washington, DC, decision-makers might get nervous about locating a dirigible base in a place called "Mountain View," since the name implied a mountainous region. Sunnyvale, Mtn. View's younger and (at the time) smaller neighbor to the south, was emphasized in campaign material instead.

The excitement over the Sunnyvale site's selection overshadowed misgivings Mtn. View residents had with the name chosen—Naval Air Station (NAS) Sunnyvale. But the prestige and economic boost of being "home" to a Navy base prompted Mtn. View's city leaders to devise plans that would more closely associate the base to the City, despite the name.

In 1930, Mtn. View Councilman Earl Minton proposed building a boulevard that would extend Castro Street to the base. At the time, the City was jockeying with Sunnyvale to be the first city to connect its downtown with the base's main entry gate. Mtn. View's new thoroughfare was to be named Moffett Boulevard, in honor of Admiral William Moffett, an esteemed Navy leader and advocate of the base's dirigible program.

The road to building the boulevard wasn't smooth . Because Mtn. View's city limits at the time extended only a few blocks north of the railroad, the City needed to build through unincorporated county land to complete the boulevard. Farmers in the area were not supportive, and in the midst of the Depression, support weakened for taxes to fund the boulevard's estimated $7,5000 price tag.



Admiral William Moffett

HIGHWAY ROUTE BEING SOUGHT

MOUNTAIN VIEW, Nov. 9.—Immediate steps toward obtaining the right-of-way for the section of Moffett Boulevard from Mountain View to the Sunnyvale naval air station outside the city limits are to be taken here following adopting of plans and specifications for continuation of the new route by the City Council.

Nov. 9, 1932 *Oakland Tribune*

Name Change Hits Snag

Mountain View Club Gives Up Plan For 'Moffett City'

Dec. 17, 1932 *Oakland Tribune*

Nevertheless, after injunctions, restraining orders, and court rulings, the purchase of the land began in 1933 and the street within the city limits was paved, ending unceremoniously at the edge of a tomato field . Finally, by May 1935, Moffett Boulevard was extended all the way to the base, completing what was dubbed "the gateway to Mountain View."

Ultimately, the name NAS Sunnyvale was short-lived. Mtn. View's name for its boulevard, on the other hand, proved to be tragically prescient. Just weeks before the base opened in 1933, the USS Akron, one of the Navy's two dirigibles, crashed off the coast of New Jersey in an electrical storm killing 73 of the 76 people onboard, including Admiral Moffett. The new base's landing field was named in his honor, and the base became popularly known as "Moffett Field." On April 20, 1942, the base officially became known as Naval Air Station (NAS) Moffett Field.

Efforts to further associate Mtn. View with the base did not end with Moffett Boulevard. In 1939, Earl Minton and other prominent civic leaders in the Mtn. View Breakfast Club began a campaign to change the City's name to "Moffett City." According to the Oakland Tribune, a meeting was held where Mtn. View's city attorney explained to the club that the name change would require approval by over 50% of the City's voters and would be an expensive endeavor. In the midst of the Great Depression, the prospect of a costly election and a costly name change was enough to shelve the proposal, ultimately ensuring that today, a trip down Moffett Boulevard will still lead you to Downtown Mtn. View—not Downtown Moffett City !

Membership

Membership Report

Submitted by June Casey
Membership Chair

Membership as of March 15, 2015

Honored Members	2
Life Members	113
Family Members	74
Single Members	116
TOTAL MEMBERSHIP	**305**

Welcome to our new members!
New Life Members: Gill Lane, John Ross
New Members: Kerrin Boynton, Pamela Baird, Greg Unangst

Volunteer Opportunities

The MVHA welcomes members interested in lending their time and talent. To sign up for the volunteer opportunities below, send an email to info@mountainviewhistorical.org or call (650) 903-6890.

Event Tabling: Greet the public at the MVHA's table at upcoming events. See Page 8 for upcoming events.

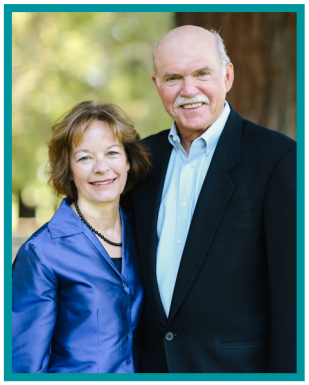
Summer BBQ: Our biggest event of the year! Looking for help with set-up, food prep, and clean-up.

Rengstorff House: The City is currently seeking volunteer docents for the historic Rengstorff House, open Tuesdays, Wednesdays and Sundays for docent-led tours! If you are available *and interested, please send an email to Kristina.Perino@mountainview.gov or call (650) 903-6073.*

Faces of the MVHA

Our organization is nothing without its wonderful members! In this feature, we shine a spotlight on members who shared a bit about themselves at our most recent event.

Pamela Baird & Greg Unangst



Year joined: 2015

Connection to Mtn. View:
"We have lived here since 1998, when we moved from Menlo Park. Both of us are active in civic and community activities." (Greg serves on the Bicycle and Pedestrian Committee and Pamela joined the Human Relations Commission in January.)

Favorite thing about the MVHA:
"We are so glad that the group exists and is researching and preserving local history. The roots of the community are much older than most people imagine."

Favorite spot in Mtn. View:
"Pamela enjoys the Castro Street scene—the Performing Arts Center and great shops and restaurants. Greg enjoys Shoreline Park and Stevens Creek Trail. (Actually, we enjoy both but couldn't decide which to select so we listed both)."

MVHA MEMBERSHIP FORM + BBQ RSVP*

The MVHA welcomes new members! By becoming a member, you are making a special investment in our mission to preserve and share Mtn. View history with the community, conserve priceless archival materials at the History Center, and hold memorable public events throughout the year. Please support the MVHA, and join us today!

- ☐ BBQ RSVP Only
- ☐ New Membership
- ☐ Membership Renewal
- ☐ Single Membership: *$15/year*
- ☐ Family Membership: *$25/year*
- ☐ Life-time Membership *$200*
- ☐ *I'm interested in volunteer opportunities*

Name: _____

Street Address: _____

City: _____

State: _____ Zip Code: _____

Telephone: _____

E-mail: _____

Please make checks payable to:
Mtn. View Historical Association

Mail to: Mtn. View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, Ca 94042

*** BBQ Invites were mailed last week but you may also use this form to RSVP. Please mail your RSVP form by Friday, July 24.**

____ # MVHA Member BBQ Ticket ($10)

____ # Guests/Non-Member BBQ Ticket ($12)
Apply for MVHA membership today & save on BBQ tickets!

____ # BBQ Ticket - Child ($5)

SUMMER / FALL

July 23 & Aug 6

Thursday, 5:30–8:00 p.m.

MVHA @ Thursday Night Live

Castro Street - Downtown Mtn. View

Come say "hi" at our table and join us on a walking tour of historic Downtown!

August 2

Sunday, 1:00–3:00 p.m.

MVHA Summer BBQ & Meeting

The Adobe Building - 157 Moffett Blvd.

See Details on Page 1

September 2

Wednesday, 6:00–8:00 p.m.

MVHA Board Meeting

M.V. Library History Center - 585 Franklin St.

Interested members are welcome to attend!

October 3

Saturday, 9:00 a.m. – 5:00 p.m.

Mtn. View High School Eagles All-Class Picnic

Cuesta Park BBQ Area - 615 Cuesta Dr.

Details still tentative.



EST. 1954

MOUNTAIN REVIEW

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

WEB: www.mountainviewhistorical.org
E-MAIL: mvha.newsletter@gmail.com

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